

Work Log #5

Reading #1

- Matthew Jockers dives into a new novel method for automatically detecting plot patterns in literary texts. The method, called "sequence alignment," involves comparing the plot sequence of a target text to a database of plot sequences from other texts. He goes on to elaborate on the technical details of the method, including how plot sequences are represented and how the comparison is performed using dynamic programming. Presenting the results of applying the method to a sample of literary texts, Jockers demonstrates the method's effectiveness in identifying plot patterns and similarities between texts. He concludes by suggesting that the method has potential applications in various fields, including literary analysis and computational stylistics, and has the potential to additionally invite further exploration and experimentation with the approach.

Jockers, Matthew. A Novel Method for Detecting Plot,

<https://www.matthewjockers.net/2014/06/05/a-novel-method-for-detecting-plot/>

- How can I apply the graphical analysis of sequence alignment to my dataset? Could visualizing such results be possible with the analysis options in Gale—such as trends in the Ngrams?

Reading #2

- Zoe Wilkinson Saldana provides a tutorial on sentiment analysis in her paper, which is defined as a technique used to identify and extract subjective information from textual data. Using Python as the programming language and introducing the TextBlob library for performing sentiment analysis, conducting sentiment analysis this way is a new and rational method that she proposes. Saldana additionally includes step-by-step instructions for loading and

preprocessing textual data, applying sentiment analysis using TextBlob, and visualizing the results using various tools. Her tutorial also covers some of the challenges and limitations of sentiment analysis, such as issues relating to accuracy and bias. Saldana emphasizes the potential usefulness of sentiment by concluding how analysis in various research domains, including digital humanities, helps provide suggestions for further exploration and research in the field.

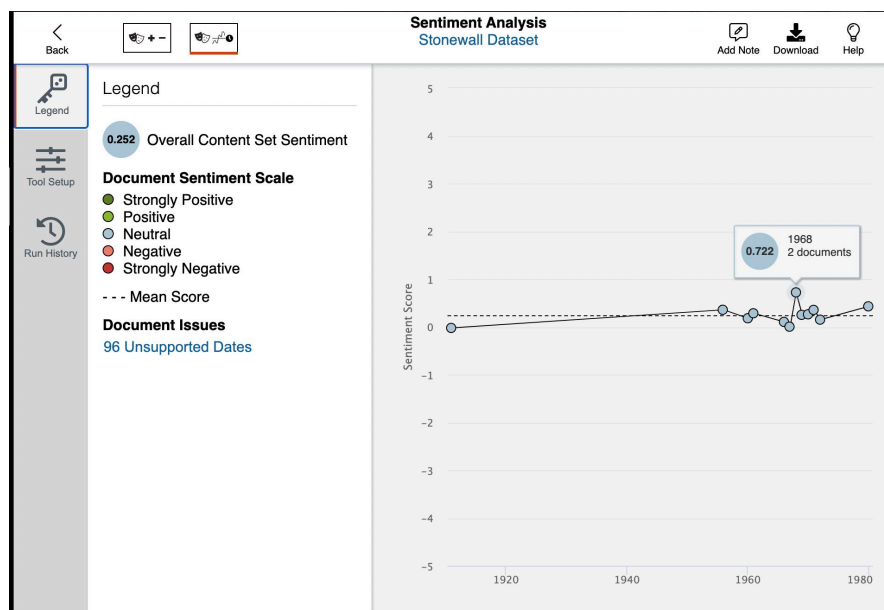
Saldaña, Zoë Wilkinson. "Sentiment Analysis for Exploratory Data Analysis."

Sentiment Analysis for Exploratory Data Analysis, 15 Jan. 2018,

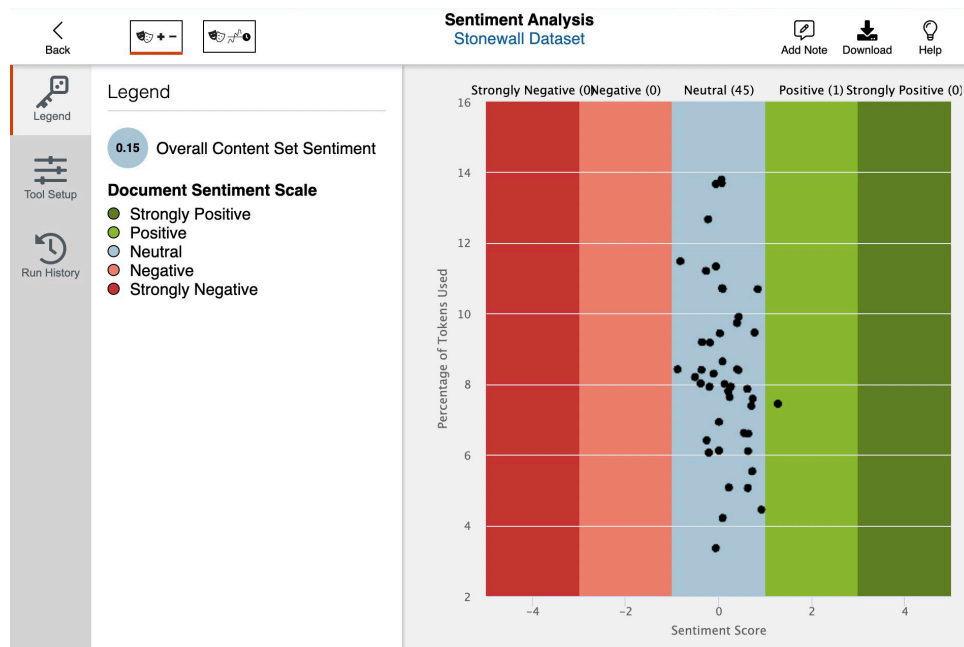
<https://programminghistorian.org/en/lessons/sentiment-analysis>.

- How can I modify the configurations within the Gale Scholar Lab analysis lab to achieve a successful sentiment analysis that increases accuracy and lessens bias?

Testing It Out:



My first run of the sentiment analysis came out as neutral. Observations on the accuracy can be seen as conflicting with 96 unsupported dates. I used the Default Cleaning Configuration as a starting point with no stop words to see what I'm working with! From this basis analysis, I can infer that neither positive nor negative affective meaning persists in this content set. With a neutral bias, the documents in the dataset seem to be credible and prepared for effective use from this initial run. Now that we have a foundation, how can I configure the settings for a more reliable result?



The second run of the sentiment analysis using the final cleaning configuration with various stop words added resulted in a cleaner, condensed, more accurate result but with the cost of a lower overall sentiment score. By adjusting the cleaning and running only the 46 supported documents, instead of including the 96 unsupported ones, we are able to make a more accurate conclusion and develop a more focused understanding of the topics in the Stonewall Dataset. This raised the question for me however if there is any way to increase the sentiment score— as no matter what configuration I did, the score had either decreased or stayed the same.

Reading #3:

- Andrew Janco writes about a workshop in the digital humanities field that focuses on the use of Spacy, a Python-based natural language processing library. The workshop covered various topics— including text preprocessing, named entity recognition, and dependency parsing. Janco goes on to explain the usefulness of Spacy in digital humanities research, particularly in analyzing large collections of textual data. Including hands-on exercises, participants

were able to apply Spacy to sample datasets and gain experience with the library's features. He concludes his log by emphasizing the importance of digital humanities tools and methods in modern research, encouraging readers to explore the field further.

Janco, Andrew. "Digital Humanities SpaCy Workshop." Medium, Medium, 16 July 2019, https://medium.com/@ajanco_76905/digital-humanities-spacy-workshop-bd71d69a4641.

- Spacy seems like a branch off Gale— with similar analysis tools that identify patterns in the text like Ngrams, clustering, or Parts of Speech! NOTE TO SELF: Keep all these resources in mind! It will be helpful

Using TimelineJS to Organize Stonewall Dataset Documents

I chose 4 documents that ascended chronologically without gaps in the years between to test run the narrative visualization of TimelineJS. Choosing TimelineJS over StorymapJS seemed more suitable for my project narrative as events during the Stonewall riots occurred in a chronological timeline for a reason. Addressing this narrative visually seemed most effective for our research question on how media coverage of the riots shaped public perception and understanding of the events.

- Timeline Visualization:
https://cdn.knightlab.com/libs/timeline3/latest/embed/index.html?source=1Par605r2f1PAET01c_bly4UrWGpWU-Pt7cRylwlAsLM&font=Default&lang=en&initial_zoom=2&height=650
- Google Doc Sheet Used:
https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/1Par605r2f1PAET01c_bly4UrWGpWU-Pt7cRylwlAsLM/edit?usp=sharing